

SolarWinds - Content Author Guide

AEM Edge Delivery Services Authoring and
Publishing

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Table of Contents

SolarWinds - Content Author Guide	3
Quick Reference	3
Access and First Page	3
Content Organization	4
Authoring Basics	4
Available Blocks	4
Page Templates	7
Sections and Section Metadata	7
Page Metadata	8
Configuration Sheets	8
Images and Links	9
Publishing Workflow	9
Common Tasks	9
Troubleshooting	10
Resources and Support	11

SolarWinds - Content Author Guide

This guide covers content authoring for the SolarWinds AEM Edge Delivery Services site. The site is a single standard site with markup content in Document Authoring. Use the Document Authoring library for the custom blocks described below; do not edit source code to make routine content changes.

Quick Reference

Resource	Link
Document Authoring	Open the SolarWinds content source
Preview	Open the main preview site
Live site	Open the production site
Block Library	Browse blocks and templates
Bulk operations	Open DA bulk operations

Site setting	Value
Organization and site	adobedrago / solarwinds-eds
Code repository	adobedrago/solarwinds-eds
Content source	https://content.da.live/adobedrago/solarwinds-eds (markup)
Site setup	One standard site

Access and First Page

Access requirements

- Request access to the SolarWinds space in Document Authoring from the site administrator.
- Ask the administrator to grant the permissions needed to preview and publish. Do not share personal access tokens.
- Use the Block Library link above when authoring. This project uses Document Authoring block tables; it does not define Universal Editor fields.

Create a page

1. Open Document Authoring and navigate to the intended content folder.
2. Create a document using the site's existing folder and naming conventions. The document path becomes its site URL, so agree on the path before publishing.
3. Add standard text, headings, images, and links. Insert a custom block from the Library at the location where it belongs, then fill in the table cells in the order described in this guide.
4. Add page metadata at the bottom of the document. At minimum, review the page title and description; preserve any existing canonical, navigation, footer, or template metadata.
5. Preview the page and check desktop and mobile layouts, links, image text alternatives, and page metadata.
6. Publish only after review. Publishing updates the live page.

Content Organization

The content source is `adobedrago/solarwinds-eds`. The repository contains a representative homepage markup file and block code, but it does not contain the complete editable Document Authoring page tree. Use Document Authoring as the source of truth for existing pages and folder structure.

The repository's importer data identifies the homepage at `/` and a French homepage at `/fr`. Blog-specific blocks and shared navigation/footer paths are also implemented for `/blog`. Confirm the current page and language folders in Document Authoring before creating a parallel page. French navigation and footer use the locale-specific paths by default when those documents exist.

Shared navigation and footer

The header loads the `/nav` document by default, and the footer loads `/footer`. Locale-specific paths such as `/fr/nav` and `/fr/footer` are used for localized pages. A page can override either location with `nav` or `footer` metadata. Blog pages use `/blog/nav` and `/blog/footer` and have a distinct layout.

Edit these shared documents in Document Authoring, preview affected pages, and publish them after review. Keep the existing sections, headings, nested link lists, image links, and labels intact unless the site administrator has approved a structural change. A navigation or footer change can affect many pages at once.

Authoring Basics

- Use the exact block name shown in the Block Library. Most custom blocks are standalone tables with a specific row and cell order; a visually similar table is not necessarily interchangeable.
- Keep heading levels and link destinations meaningful. Use a heading for a title, not just to make text larger.
- For blocks that style a call to action, follow the documented paragraph and emphasis pattern. Some blocks require a paragraph containing only the link; others use bold or italic link text to distinguish buttons.
- Keep related content together in the same row or cell. Do not reorder or omit cells unless the block notes say they are optional.
- Add useful alt text to informative images. Use empty alt text only for decorative images whose meaning is already provided by adjacent text.
- Preview after changing a block with multiple rows, optional media, or links. These structures often render differently on narrow screens.

Available Blocks

The repository has 31 block folders. Named custom blocks are the author-facing choices in the Library. Base blocks are the shared rendering foundation; header and footer are site chrome, not blocks to insert into page content.

Block	Use and authoring shape
<code>cards</code>	General card grid foundation. Each row becomes a card; an image-only cell is treated as its image and the remaining cells become the card body. Prefer a purpose-built <code>cards-*</code> entry when available.
<code>cards-authors</code>	Featured author profiles. One row per author, two cells: square headshot, then linked name and job-title paragraph. The name link makes the card clickable; use the branded headshots.

Block	Use and authoring shape
cards-catalog	Filterable product catalog. Optional first one-cell sidebar note; one-cell category rows containing only an H2; then three-cell product rows: card copy, product type (SaaS or Self-Hosted), and optional overview content. Product rows belong to the preceding category.
cards-feature	Short resource or feature teasers. Use one card per row with a heading, description, and CTA link. Follow the existing example for exact cell grouping.
cards-posts	Blog post teasers. One row per post, two cells: optional linked image; then optional category links, linked H3 title, date, and author link. A date author line is supported.
cards-pricing	Pricing tiers. One card per row with tier H3, starting-price label, bold price, billing unit, quote link, and a feature list. Keep price and billing units explicit.
cards-products	Product pricing list. One row per product: icon, product name and offer details, intro/features, and deployment type (SaaS or Self-Hosted). Use the source product icon and preserve the four-cell order.
cards-resources	Resource cards. One row per card with image in the first cell and an eyebrow/category plus linked title in the second. The first card may be displayed as the featured wide card.
cards-tools	Tool-pricing grid. One row per tool: icon, linked tool name and price/CTA details, and deployment type (SaaS or Self-Hosted).
carousel	General carousel foundation. Each row is one slide; the cells hold slide image and slide content. Two or more rows show carousel controls.
carousel-testimonial	Customer testimonial carousel. One row per testimonial, two cells: company logo, then quote, CTA, customer name, title, and company.
columns	General multi-column foundation. Each row is a row of columns; keep the number and order of cells consistent. An image-only column is treated as media. Prefer a purpose-built columns-* entry when available.
columns-awards	Awards feature. One row with heading content and award badge images. Use the provided badge assets and keep image alternatives descriptive.
columns-callout	Blog/event promotion. One row, two cells: copy (H2, paragraphs, final link-only CTA paragraph) and image (optionally linked). Cell order controls which side holds the image. The optional background block option adds the patterned band.
columns-event	Event promotion, used for the French homepage event band. One row, two cells: optional linked image, then H2, paragraphs, and a final link-only CTA paragraph. The band and decoration are generated by the block.
columns-logos	Customer logo row. One row with a heading cell and a cell containing the customer logos.

Block	Use and authoring shape
columns-podcast	Blog podcast feature. One row, two cells: episode heading, Wistia media link, tag links and date; then optional episode image. The player is lazy-loaded and remains a link if media cannot load.
columns-stats	Statistics row. One row with three statistic columns; each column contains a prominent number and its descriptor.
columns-topics	Featured blog topics. One row with one cell per topic (additional rows add topics). Each cell starts with a linked H3, followed by linked post titles and date/author details.
footer	Automatically loads and decorates the shared footer document. Edit / footer in Document Authoring; do not insert this block into page content.
fragment	Includes content from another site path. Use only an approved fragment path; changes to the source fragment can affect every page that includes it.
header	Automatically loads and decorates the shared navigation document. Edit / nav in Document Authoring; do not insert this block into page content.
hero	General hero foundation. Use a purpose-built hero-* entry from the Library for the intended hero layout.
hero-banner	Contact or CTA band. Use an optional row of decorative images, followed by the heading and a paragraph containing only the CTA link. The layout changes automatically when images are omitted.
hero-blog	Featured blog post. One-column table with linked image, then linked H2, date, author link, and category link. Metadata paragraphs after the heading become the post meta line.
hero-split	Homepage hero. One column containing the hero image followed by H1, supporting copy, and CTA. No variation is documented.
section-metadata	Section-level style/data settings. Add a two-cell key/value row, such as Style and dark, at the end of the section. The block applies the setting and removes itself from the rendered page.
tabs	General tabs foundation. One row per tab: first cell is the tab label and remaining content is the panel. Keep labels unique and panel content under its matching row.
tabs-deployment	Deployment filter. Optional first one-cell heading row, then two-cell rows for each option: label and supporting label. Use the documented SaaS, All, and Self-Hosted options.
tabs-solutions	Four solution tabs. Each row has two cells: tab label, then panel content (icon image, optional Wistia link, body copy, CTA, capabilities heading, and link list). The pie illustration is shown only with exactly four tabs.
widget	Loads a coded widget from a /widgets/... URL. This is an integration point, not a general-purpose author

Block	Use and authoring shape
	block; use only a widget and URL approved by the site administrator.

Complex block notes

Product catalog: In `cards-catalog`, a category row contains only an H2. Every following three-cell product row is grouped under that category until the next H2 row. The second cell supplies filter data and may not be visible in the card. The third cell is optional overview-modal content. Do not put product details in the wrong cell; the block builds filters from the category headings and product-type values.

Products and tools: `cards-products` and `cards-tools` use one cell for filter data as well as visible content. Use only the exact deployment labels supported by the block. A missing or misspelled label can cause the item to be excluded from a deployment filter.

Tabs and media: For `tabs-solutions` and `columns-podcast`, author Wistia links using the existing media URL pattern in the block notes. The first image or media link has a specific role. Keep the title and link text descriptive because the title may also be used for player accessibility.

Page Templates

No author-selectable page-template directory or template catalog is present in this repository. `tools/importer/page-templates.json` documents imported page examples and their block composition; it is not a Document Authoring template library.

Template	Purpose	Metadata / application
Blog layout	The code recognizes a blog page class and switches the header/footer to blog-specific fragments and styling.	Use the existing blog page as the model. Confirm the approved template value and required metadata with the site administrator before applying it to a new page.
Other page templates	None documented in the repository.	Check the Document Authoring Library and an existing page of the same type. Do not infer a template name from an importer entry.

Sections and Section Metadata

Sections divide a page into horizontal content groups. A section break in Document Authoring starts a new section. To set a section style, add a Section Metadata block at the end of that section with `Style` in the first cell and the style name in the second. Multiple comma-separated style values are accepted by the implementation, but use only combinations already approved on an existing page.

The repository defines section classes for `blog-hero`, `cool-grey`, `dark`, `highlight`, `light`, `light-grey`, `light-teal`, `panel`, `spotlight`, `teal`, and `teal-gradient`. The effect can depend on which block is in the section; use the closest approved page as a visual reference.

Important: The checked-in homepage markup includes `orange` and `grey` section metadata, but no matching section-style selectors were found in the current repository CSS. Do not rely on those two values for new pages without confirming the intended appearance with the site administrator.

Page Metadata

Add or preserve page metadata in the metadata table at the bottom of the document. The local homepage demonstrates title and description; the importer record also tracks a canonical URL. Review metadata before publishing.

Property	When to use	Guidance
title	Every page	Write a unique, concise page title that identifies the page.
description	Every page	Write a page-specific summary suitable for search and sharing.
image	When a page-specific share image is needed	Use a published site image path and verify the preview crop.
canonical	When the canonical URL differs from the page default	Set only when the content owner has confirmed the canonical destination.
template	Pages using an approved special layout, such as the blog layout	Use the exact value from an existing approved page. No general template list is checked in.
nav / footer	Pages intentionally using non-default shared documents	Use the approved fragment path. Otherwise the site selects the locale's default shared document.

Configuration Sheets

The repository does not contain live `placeholders.json`, `redirects.json`, or a `bulk metadata.json` sheet at its root. These are content-source documents managed in Document Authoring when present; confirm they exist in DA before editing. A JSON or metadata file in `storybook` or `import-work` is a development/import artifact, not the live authoring sheet.

Sheet	Expected DA location	Purpose and author action
Placeholders	<code>/placeholders</code> (and locale-specific folders where configured)	Reusable UI labels, including carousel controls. The site loads this sheet at runtime. Update approved translations here; <code>storybook/public/placeholders.json</code> is only a Storybook fixture.
Redirects	<code>/redirects</code>	Map a retired source path to its destination. Before deleting or renaming a published page, ask the administrator to confirm the sheet and its current column format, add the redirect, and publish the sheet.
Bulk metadata	<code>/metadata</code> if configured	Apply metadata changes across matching page paths. Use the bulk operations app and review affected URLs before applying updates. No live sheet is present in the repository.

Images and Links

- Add images through the Document Authoring media picker or drag-and-drop. Check the final image path in preview.
- Write alt text that communicates the image's useful information. For a decorative logo next to a company name or a decorative hero image, use the existing page's accessibility pattern rather than repeating visible text.
- Use descriptive filenames and appropriate source dimensions. Review crop and image placement at mobile and desktop widths.
- Make link text describe its destination. Verify external links and any links embedded in card, tab, CTA, or image cells.
- Blocks that accept Wistia media should use the Wistia URL shape shown in their block notes; do not paste an unrelated embed URL into those cells.

Publishing Workflow

Stage	Location	Purpose
Edit	Document Authoring	Make and save content changes.
Preview	main--solarwinds-eds--adobedrago.aem.page	Review layout, links, images, meta-data, and responsive behavior before release.
Publish	Document Authoring	Publish the approved document or shared content.
Live	main--solarwinds-eds--adobedrago.aem.live	Confirm the published production page.

Workflow: Edit in Document Authoring, preview the page, correct issues, publish, then verify the live URL. A live publish is production-facing. Shared navigation, footer, and fragment changes can affect multiple pages, so review their impact before publishing.

For a folder, language, or multiple-document operation, use [DA bulk operations](#) and verify the selected paths before applying the change.

Common Tasks

Task	Steps
Create a page	Navigate to the correct DA folder, create the document, add content and Library blocks, add title and description metadata, preview, then publish.
Edit a page	Open the existing document in DA, preserve its block/cell structure and metadata, preview the page, then publish.
Update the main navigation	Edit /nav in DA; for a localized page, confirm whether its locale-specific nav is used. Preview representative pages before publishing.
Update the blog navigation	Edit /blog/nav in DA and review blog pages at desktop and mobile sizes before publishing.

Task	Steps
Update the footer	Edit / footer; for blog or localized pages, verify the matching fragment path. Preview affected pages before publishing.
Add a product	Use the existing product row in cards-catalog, cards-products, or cards-tools as appropriate. Preserve cell order and supported deployment labels.
Add a blog post teaser	Add a row to the relevant blog card block. Check linked image, title, category, date, and author independently.
Change a section appearance	Add or edit the Section Metadata block at the end of the section. Use a locally implemented style and verify the result in preview.
Retire or move a page	Confirm the destination and redirect with the administrator, update and publish the redirects sheet if configured, then remove or move the source page. Verify both URLs.
Update text used by controls	Check whether the label is a placeholder. If so, update the appropriate locale's DA placeholders sheet and test the control in preview.

Troubleshooting

Issue	What to check
Block is unstyled or content is missing	Confirm the exact Library block name, row count, cell order, and required heading/link formatting. Compare with an existing page using the same block.
Product does not appear under a filter	Check its category H2, exact SaaS / Self-Hosted value, and the expected product row/cell placement.
Tab or carousel content is incorrect	Confirm each tab/slide is a separate row and that its label, image, media link, and content are in the correct cells.
Section color or background is not applied	Check the Section Metadata key is Style and the value matches an implemented style. The homepage's orange and grey values are not implemented by current local section CSS.
Navigation or footer changes do not appear	Confirm the correct locale or blog fragment was edited, preview/publish that shared document, and check the page's nav or footer override.
Image is missing or wrong	Confirm the image was uploaded to the content source, the path is correct, and the intended image is in the image cell rather than the copy cell.
Page title or search summary is wrong	Check title and description in the page metadata table, then preview and publish the page.
Published page still shows old content	Confirm the correct document was published and hard-refresh the live page. If it remains stale, contact the site administrator.

Resources and Support

Resource	Link
Document Authoring documentation	docs.da.live
AEM authoring documentation	Authoring content
Placeholders documentation	Placeholders
Redirects documentation	Redirects
Support	Contact the SolarWinds site administrator; project-specific support contacts are not documented in this repository.